Clinical Simulation for student role playing physiotherapist

Neuro Physiotherapy – BSc Physiotherapy (Year 2)

Student Role: Physiotherapist

Patient: Mr ABC, 58 years

Diagnosis: Right MCA Stroke

Stage: 3 weeks post-stroke

Patient Scenario

Mr ABC is a 58-year-old man who had a right-sided stroke 3 weeks ago. He has been referred to physiotherapy due to walking and balance difficulties.

He currently:

- Uses a quad stick;
- Walks short distances;
- Requires supervision, especially when turning;
- Reports feeling less confident on one side;
- Is medically stable and able to communicate clearly.

Your Role as the Physiotherapist

During this 60-minute clinical simulation, you are expected to:

☐ Introduce yourself and gain consent
☐ Carry out a subjective assessment

☐ Perform a focused objective observation (safely)
☐ Explain your clinical reasoning
☐ Suggest an initial management plan

Safety Guidelines

☐ Stay close during standing and walking
☐ Do not rush the patient
☐ Reassure throughout

☐ Maintain patient safety at all times
☐ Prioritise safety over performance

1. Introduction & Consent

Student Task

Write **1–2 key points** you would include when introducing yourself and explaining the session to the patient.

Notes:

Hints

- Clear introduction

- Explain what you will assess
- Reassure an anxious patient

2. Subjective Assessment

Student Task

Write **at least TWO subjective questions** you would ask the patient and document their answers

Question 1:

Question 1 Answer:

Question 2:

Question 2 Answer:

(Optional)

Question 3:

Question 3 Answer:

Hints to Guide Your Question Choice

Think about asking questions related to:

- Situations where the patients balance feels most difficult;
- Confidence or fear during walking;
- Activities that feel unsafe;
- What the patient wants to improve most

Ask yourself: **How will this question help guide my assessment or treatment?**

3. Objective Observation

You are now asked to observe the patient.

Safety Rules

- Do NOT remove the walking aid
- Always stay close
- Do NOT rush the patient

Student Task

Write down **what you observe**, not what you expect to see.

Standing posture:

Balance in standing:

Walking with quad stick:

Turning:

4. Clinical Reasoning

Student Task

Briefly explain why the patient may be unsteady and less confident.

Explanation:

Hints

Think about the relationship between:

- Stroke and movement changes;
- Balance, confidence, and safety.

5. Initial Management Plan

Student Task

Part A) State the aims of the treatment plan.

Aim 1:

Aim 2:

Hints

Think about:

- Balance
- Weight-bearing
- Gait safety
- Confidence
- Supervision

Part B) Write and briefly explain 2–3 points describing the treatment exercises based on the aims you have set in Part A):